How a Decision Gets Made

Simplified. Exact steps vary; check the posted agenda for each meeting.

How a school district decision gets made

1. **Staff or a work group drafts it.** Example: the weighted grades work group, with students in it.
2. **A Board committee or the Committee of the Whole discusses it.** Example: Nov 2 (Teaching & Learning Committee) and Nov 9 (Committee of the Whole).
3. **It goes on a regular Board meeting agenda for a vote.** Public comment usually comes near the start.
4. **The Board votes.** A majority passes it.
5. **District staff carry it out.** That's when "you said, we did" gets tested.

Where students can step in: join the work group, email Board members before steps 2 and 3, speak during public comment, and check that step 5 happens.

How a city budget decision gets made

1. **Departments request funding.** Example: SPPD's plan to move from Flock to Axon.
2. **Staff and the Mayor put together a proposed budget.**
3. **Committees and budget work sessions review it.** Example: Oct 27 and Nov 10 work sessions.
4. **The Common Council holds a public hearing and adopts the budget.** Planned for Nov 17.
5. **Contracts and policies follow.** The Axon contract, Policy F-18 and data-sharing agreements come after the money is approved.

Where residents can step in: email alders before step 3, speak at the budget hearing in step 4, and ask for contract terms to be public before step 5.